should be baths, and an oven, for the same purposes as in the gaols. In some county bridewells there are from ten to twenty prisoners, and in Tothill-fields and Clerkenwell many more. Great care should be taken to prevent infection; to keep the house clean, and well aired: and invariably to adhere to strict rules of sobriety and diligence, in order to correct the faults of prisoners, and make them for the future useful to society. Gentle discipline is commonly more efficacious than severity; which should not be exercised but on such as will not be amended by lenity. These should be punished by solitary confinement on bread and water, for a time proportioned to their fault.[1] Endeavours should be used to persuade the offender that he is corrected only for his own good. The keeper should, by all means, reside in the house. He should not be suffered to farm any part of the allowance: nor to sell liquor, or anything else. I have often observed, that bridewells are cleaner and quieter where keepers have no licence. He should have no fees,[2] but a salary proportioned to the trust, that he may not be obliged to follow any business out of the house. The whole management should be frequently examined, in the same manner as that of a gaol, and by the same sort of inspectors. In the house there should be a room for the magistrates, as there is in foreign houses of correction, similar to the governors' room in hospitals,

oak. The beds or cradles at Plymouth are fourteen inches from the floor: three feet one inch high at the head, and two feet three inches at the feet: six feet two inches long, and three feet one inch wide in the clear. The boards on the sides (three feet eight inches long) slide in an inch groove. A medicine box hangs by two hooks at the back of each cradle, which is necessary only in infirmaries. To these cradles are hair mattresses, bedding, etc. If offenders have only loose straw, though with a coverlet, they must lie in their clothes, and of necessity be dirty and sickly objects. Therefore proper bedding is necessary. Without this, how can habits of cleanliness be produced and promoted in young creatures? or what disposition can such have for work?

[1] The notion, that convicts are ungovernable, is certainly erroneous. There is a mode of managing some of the most desperate, with ease to yourself, and advantage to them. Many of them are shrewd and sensible: manage them with calmness, yet with steadiness: show them that you have humanity, and that you aim to make them useful members of society: let them see and hear the rules and orders of the prison, and be convinced that they are not defrauded in their provisions or clothes by contractors or gaolers. When they are sick, let them be treated with tenderness. Such conduct would prevent mutiny in prisons, and attempts to escape; which I am fully persuaded are often owing to prisoners being made desperate, by the inhumanity and ill usage of their keepers.

[2] Many young creatures, when their term is expired, are detained in prison, others stripped of a remaining handkerchief, apron, or petticoat, such necessaries have I seen left with the keepers till they could bring their fees.

and in the houses of industry in Suffolk and Norfolk. The courts of justice sat in the prisons in Scotland formerly; and this is still the case in some of the towns. This would be attended with many advantages. Mr. Henry Fielding remarks, that "The sufferings of the poor are indeed less observed than their misdeeds; not from any want of compassion, but because they are less known; and this is the true reason why we so often hear them mentioned with abhorrence, and so seldom with pity."

I have before said, that I am no advocate for luxury in prisons; for I would have no meat diet for criminals in houses of correction, or at most, only on Sundays. Yet I would plead, that they should have a pound and half of good household bread a day, and a quart of good beer: besides twice a day a quart of warm soup made from peas, rice, milk or barley. For a change they might sometimes have turnips, carrots, or potatoes. It may be said, this diet will starve those who work in houses of correction: but I am persuaded of the contrary; by what I have seen abroad, in the galleys, in the houses of correction, and among the most robust labourers. Though I am sensible that persons confined, whose minds are depressed, need more nourishment than such as are at liberty.

I know not any reason why a house of correction may not be conducted with as much regularity, as any other house where the family is equally numerous. Some foreign bridewells are so conducted. Let the sober and diligent be distinguished by some preference in their diet, or lodging; or by shortening the term of their confinement: and giving them, when discharged, a good character. This last will be a strong incitement to good behaviour. The hours of rising, of reading a chapter in the Bible, of prayers, of meals, of work, etc. should all be fixed by the magistrates, and notice of them given by a bell. A chaplain is necessary here in every view. To reform prisoners, or to make them better as to their morals, should always be the leading view in every house of correction, and their earnings should only be a secondary object. As rational and immortal beings we owe this to them; nor can any criminality of theirs justify our neglect in this particular. The last recited author says: "Religion will, I am satisfied, have a strong influence in correcting the morals of men; and I am no less persuaded, that it is religion alone which can effectually accomplish so great and so desirable a work."

Some have supposed that the profit of the work in a house of